

Swimming

The art

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Preview edition

Chapter 1

Float

To swim first is to float.

Explain notes

- The water is there to help you to swim.

Chapter 2

Relax

Muscles that do not need to be used should be relaxed.

Chapter 3

Meditation

Swimming is meditation.

Chapter 4

Art

Swimming is an art.

Chapter 5

Observe

Observe before entering the water.

Explain notes

- At the beach, observe the waves.
- In a swimming pool, observe the spaces.

Chapter 6

Swim

Enter the water and swim.

Explain notes

- Enter where you can.

Chapter 7

Crowded

No matter how crowded, you can swim there.

Explain notes

- A crowded pool has spaces that keeps changing.

Chapter 8

Shallow

No matter how shallow, you can swim there.

Chapter 9

Get out

*When to get out may depend on whether able to
swim there or not.*

Chapter 10

Goal

Swim without a goal.

Explain notes

- Swimming how long doesn't really matter.
- Swimming how far doesn't really matter.

Chapter 11

Fun

Swimming should be fun.

Chapter 12

Pool

Swim in the pool as if you are walking in a street.

Chapter 13

Beach

Swim at the beach not affected by the waves.

Explain notes

- Waves make it more fun.

Chapter 14

Freestyle

Choose freestyle.

Chapter 15

Breathing

Breathing on one side.

One breath every four strokes.

Chapter 16

Eyes

Should look at the bottom of the water.

Explain notes

- So your neck can be relaxed.

Chapter 17

Rhythm

Swim in a rhythm that suits you best.

Chapter 18

Mistake

*Do not swim longer than needed.
That will make the same mistakes longer.*

Chapter 19

Teacher

Forget about what you learnt from a teacher.

Chapter 20

Routine

Wake up, brush teeth, go to swim.

Chapter 21

Passion

Swimming is no longer a passion.

Chapter 22

Habit

Swimming is not a habit.

Chapter 23

Change

Swimming is infinite change.

Chapter 24

Ideas

Swimming is source of ideas.

Chapter 25

Wisdom

Swimming is source of wisdom.

Chapter 26

Feel

Swimming is feeling what the water is like.

Explain notes

- Feel what it is like and you will become water.

Chapter 27

Balance

Swimming is balance.

Chapter 28

Hands

Hands can pull back at any time.

Hands can push water to the sides.

The same hand can pull two times in a row.

Chapter 29

Head

Head can come out of the water and look to any direction steadily.

Chapter 30

Legs

Legs can stretch out to keep balance.

Chapter 31

Knees

Knees can touch the bottom of the pool.

Chapter 32

Toes

Toes can push the lower body up.

Chapter 33

Body

The body can tilt upwards.

The body can bend up in the middle.

Explain notes

- Both ways keep the head up, and you can see more above the water.

Chapter 34

Wave

*A hand can also be used to wave above the water
to greet a friend.*

Chapter 35

Movement

Movement should be as soft as water.

Chapter 36

Form

*How to swim doesn't really matter.
Shallow or deep is really the same.
Change the form accordingly.*

Chapter 37

Circles

Try to swim in small circles at the beach.

Chapter 38

Every pool

Try to swim in every pool.

Chapter 39

Lane

In a swimming pool, you do not have to hold a lane.

Explain notes

- You can swim left or right and find your lane within the spaces.
- It will eventually be your lane when you follow the same path, even if it is not a straight line.

Chapter 40

Fast lane

Avoid swimming in a fast lane if possible.

Chapter 41

Guarding

Guard with your upper arm touching theirs.

Guard their legs.

Guard your chest.

Explain notes

- Palm can face upwards.

Chapter 42

Space

Better, place your hand there and leave some space.

Chapter 43

Elsewhere

Best swim elsewhere.

Chapter 44

Compare

Do not compare with others.

Only compare with yourself.

Chapter 45

Pass

When a faster swimmer is passing you, let them pass.

Chapter 46

Steady

There is no swimming fast, but there is swimming steady.

Explain notes

- Do not swim to exhaust your body.
- The best swimming is like having not been swimming.

Chapter 47

Suit

Wear a scuba diver suit and you can still swim at a good speed.

Explain notes

- It becomes part of your body.
- It makes you like a balloon, so you float more at the beach, therefore safer.

Chapter 48

Alert

Better no need to stay alert than have to.

Explain notes

- When you stay alert, you cannot enter the flow state.
- You need to stay alert because you are too close to another swimmer, or because you have not found your way in the water.

Chapter 49

Reflection

*Think of a time you were calm in this pool and
compare what it was like with now.*

Chapter 50

Master swimmer

A master swimmer inspires others by showing them what they thought was not possible.

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